

Michael Jacobs

Michael.jacobs@gess.ethz.ch
Public Policy Group, ETH Zürich
Leonhardshalde 21
Zürich 8001

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT	Postdoctorate at Public Policy Group, ETH Zurich, Switzerland 2025-2028 Postdoctoral researcher on <i>Swiss National Science Foundation</i> funded project: 'Improving the Quality of Online Public Discourse'. Responsible for overseeing, coordinating, and supporting the group's project, including with respect to study design, data collection, field protocols, data analysis plans, drafting manuscripts and disseminating results to academics, policy makers and the public.
EDUCATION	University College London 2021-2025 PhD in Political Science, awarded in September 2025 Thesis: " <i>Better to be Maligned than Ignored? The Use of (Disruptive) Protest to Shape Public Discourse and Public Opinion</i> " Supervision: Prof Ben Lauderdale, Dr Katerina Tertytchnaya & Dr Jack Blumenau London School of Economics and Political Science 2017-2018 MSc, Political Science and Political Economy With Distinction University of Durham 2013-2017 BA in Politics, Philosophy and Economics First Class Honours Year abroad at University of Hong Kong
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Themes: Political Communication, Contentious Politics, Public Opinion Methods: Causal Inference, Text-as-Data, NLP, Measurement
PUBLICATIONS	Michael Jacobs. " <i>Breaking into the Public Sphere: How Protest Tactics Shape Media Visibility?</i> " - Forthcoming at <i>BJPS</i>
WORKING PAPERS	Michael Jacobs. " <i>Do Unpopular Tactics Undermine the Persuasiveness of Protest?</i> " - Revise and Resubmit at <i>APSR</i> Michael Jacobs. " <i>How Effective are Protests at Shifting Public Discourse in Activists' Preferred Direction?</i> " Presented at APSA conference 2024, under review at <i>AJPS</i>
TEACHING	Tutorial Instructor at ETH Zürich, Switzerland 2026 Methods IV: Introduction to Statistical Learning, (PG)

	Guest Lecturer at the University College London, UK 2025 Quantitative Text Analysis for Social Science, (UG & PG) Developed and delivered two 2hr lectures on deep learning language models.
	Teaching Assistant at the London School of Economics, UK 2023 Introduction to Data Science and Machine Learning, Summer School (UG & PG)
	Teaching Assistant at University College London, UK Democracy and Authoritarianism (UG) 2023 Causal Analysis (Q-step) (UG) 2022, 2024
	Teaching Assistant at King's College London, UK 2021 Principles of Economics (UG)
OTHER EMPLOYMENT	UCL - Research Assistant 2024 Research Assistant for project seeking to measure the climate policy positions of political parties in advanced democracies. Tasks involved auditing and improving an analysis pipeline for collecting texts from an API, tokenising into sentences, and preparing for manual labelling.
	UK Treasury - Policy Advisor, Personal Tax, Welfare, Pensions 2020-2021 Policy development in the area of pensions tax. Contributed to the development of tax policy with respect to the remedy for age discrimination in the 2015 public service pension reforms (the McCloud case).
	UK Treasury - Policy Advisor, Enterprise and Growth Unit 2018-2020 Spending control for the Department for Business, Energy and Industrial Strategy (BEIS) with respect to automotive and aerospace sector policy (around 200m p.a.), over the course of two budgets and the 2019 Spending Round.
CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS	APSA Annual Meeting, presentation 2024 ECPR General Conference, presentation 2024 Organiser & participant of UCL Conflict & Change PhD Workshop 2023, 2024 'Text as Data Reading Group', presentation 2023 Digital Democracy Workshop, University of Zurich, presentation 2023 EPSA Annual Conference, presentation 2023 UCL Conflict & Change PhD Workshop, presentation 2022, 2023
GRADUATE METHODS TRAINING	Advanced Methods for Text as Data, Essex Summer School (unassessed) 2022 Time Series Econometrics, UCL (audited) 2022 Foundations of Machine Learning, UCL (audited) 2021 Qualitative Methods: Case Studies and Comparative Analysis, UCL (73%) 2021 Causal Inference for Observational and Experimental Studies, LSE (88%) 2018 Quantitative Text Analysis, LSE (87%) 2018 Applied Regression Analysis, LSE (89%) 2017

GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS	UCL Political Science Departmental Research Fund Grant (to perform survey experiment on persuasive effects of protest) Value: £8,800	2024
	ESRC Doctoral Scholarship (Quantitative Methods Enhancement). Value: £20,000 p.a.	2021-25
AWARDS	UCL PGTA Excellence in Student Feedback Award	2024
	LSE Winner of the Msc Political Science and Political Economy prize for best overall performance (highest overall grade in the Msc cohort, 85%)	2018
	Durham J.S. Mill prize for best performance in UG PPE cohort.	2017
	Durham Award for best UG dissertation in politics department (achieving a mark of 93%) on “Do Voters Trust Politicians that Pander? Policy Platforms as a Signal of Character”.	2017
SOFTWARE	$\text{\LaTeX}$ (good), R (proficient), R Markdown (proficient), Python (intermediate)	